

AKARSHIK BANERJEE

+1 (608)-982-4493 | akarshik.banerjee@gwu.edu | Washington DC

EDUCATION

2023 – 2028 (expected)	PhD in Economics The George Washington University (GWU)
2021 – 2023	MS in Consumer Economics GPA – 4.0 out of 4.0 Rank 1 out of 4 University of Wisconsin – Madison (UW Madison)
2015 – 2017	MA in Economics 7.18 out of 9 GPA Equivalent – 4.0 Rank 6 out of 120 Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), India
2012 – 2015	BSc with Honors in Economics 601 out of 800 GPA Equivalent – 4.0 Rank 7 out of ~2000+ Scottish Church College, Calcutta University, India

RESEARCH FIELDS

Economic Development, Gender, Behavioral Economics, Experimental Design

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Research Positions

Dec 2023 – Present	Research Consultant Centre for Social and Behaviour Change, Ashoka University, India Secured a \$60,000 grant (10% acceptance rate) to lead a follow-up study on the long-run impact of smartphone access on women's empowerment using adaptive treatment assignment based on revealed preferences. Built large-scale datasets and conducted reproducible causal analysis, including ML-based treatment effect estimation, to inform parallel experiments and program scale-up.
Jun 2025 – Aug 2025	Student Research Specialist GWU Conducted spatial and statistical analysis on urban economic data using Stata, QGIS, and Google Earth; developed reproducible workflows integrating GitHub and Google Colab for data visualization and geospatial mapping
Oct 2023 – Aug 2024	Research Assistant GWU Data analysis using large scale survey data, causal inference, grant writing and project management on development economics topics in Tanzania, Ghana, India and Bangladesh
May 2022 – Aug 2022	Short Term Consultant The World Bank Supported the design and implementation of a multi-arm, school-based experiment in Bangladesh using vignette interventions to shift adolescents' gender norms; built analytical features and presented findings to World Bank teams and identified measurement issues in the implicit association test (IAT), recommending design corrections that informed the endline survey.
Oct 2021 – Jan 2022	Behavioral Insights for Policy Fellow Ashoka University, India Lab-in-the-field experiments in neighboring matrilineal and patrilineal societies in India to study gender differences in moral hazard behavior using Probit regression. (among the 18 selected applicants out of 200)

Teaching Positions

Aug 2025 & 2026	Math Camp Instructor GWU – 16 students in PhD Economics courses Taught linear algebra, multivariate calculus, and real analysis; designed and evaluated exams
Aug 2024 – Present	Graduate Assistant GWU – 10 students PhD in Economics Course Evaluation – 4.9 / 5 Conducting weekly lectures on Microeconomics including Consumer Theory, Theory of Firms, General Equilibrium, Stochastic Dominance, Game Theory
Jun 2022 – Aug 2022	Primary Instructor UW Madison – 18 Undergraduates Course Evaluation – 4.7 / 5 Involved in designing and conduct of a summer course on “Consumers and the Market”. Responsibilities include holding office hours, preparing evaluation material, lecture videos, and grading.
Jan 2022 – May 2023	Teaching Assistant - Applied Microeconomics UW Madison Grading and holding TA sessions for an undergraduate applied microeconomics course

WORKING PAPERS

May the Phone be With You: Impact of Smartphone Ownership on Women's Empowerment
Ain't Gonna Work on Maggie's Farm No More? Job Quality and Capabilities in Ghana (with Hugo Blunch and James Foster)
“I Have Grown Confidence in Me”: Shifting Adolescent Mindsets on Schooling, (with Jennifer Seager)
Power Gender Resource Theory: Linking Neighborhood Wealth Comparisons and Wife Abuse in India
Long-term Access to Microfinance Does Not Improve Intra-Household Bargaining Power of Women (with Shagata Mukherjee)
Impact of Gender Mindset on IPV: Evidence from Tribal Population in India

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

2026	\$3,000 – Mathematic Excellence Instructional Award
2026	\$4,500 – George and May Shiers Memorial Award
2026	\$60,000 – BRAC Women’s Economic Empowerment and Digital Connectivity Grant
2025	\$3,000 – Elliot School Award for Research Excellence
2025	\$6,000 – Summer Graduate Research Assistantship Award
2025	\$3,000 – Mathematic Excellence Instructional Assistantship Award
2023	\$2,325 – Summer Time Academic Research Award
2023	\$59,294 – GWU Graduate Student Fellowship (4% acceptance rate)
2023	\$500 – Graduate Student Teaching Excellence Award
2022	\$24,720 – Short Term Consultant with The World Bank
2021	\$1,750 – Consumer Sciences Graduate Student Scholarship
2021	\$45,818 – UW Madison Graduate Student Fellowship
2019	\$27,000 – Junior Research Fellowship award in Economics, University Grants Commission (1% acceptance rate)
2015	Merit Scholarship for ranking 1 st in MA entrance exam for Jawaharlal Nehru University (2% acceptance rate)
2013	Merit scholarship for ranking 1 st in BSc Economics first year exam at Calcutta University

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software	– STATA, GitHub, Google Colab, R, Python, SAS, SQL, MS Excel, VBA, MATLAB
Modeling Techniques	– Linear, Logistic, Tobit, Probit, Fractional Regression, RDD, DID, Random Forest, ARIMA (p,d,q)

CORPORATE EXPERIENCE

Jul 2019 to Jul 2021	Analyst Decision Sciences HSBC Model developer for France’s small business portfolio, involved in predicting the probability of default for customers and prescribing capital reserve requirements in case of stressed economic scenarios
Sep 2017 to Jun 2019	Data Scientist EXL Analytics Pvt. Ltd. Developed machine learning models for a US based Fortune 40 Retail Company to provide solutions to prediction problems involving customer churn, upgrade and upsell

CONFERENCES AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Jan 2026	ASSA 2026 Annual Meeting Philadelphia, PA
Oct 2025	Presented at: North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA), Tucson, Arizona
July 2025	Conference of the society for the study of economic inequality (ECINEQ) Washington DC
May 2025	Guest Lecture to undergraduate Economics students at Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies (TeIAS)
Apr 2025	Washington Area Development Economics Symposium (WADES) Conference Arlington, Virginia
Apr 2025	Presented at: South East Exchange of Development Studies (SEEDS) Conference Atlanta, Georgia
Jan 2025	ASSA 2025 Annual Meeting San Francisco, CA
Nov 2024	Presented at: Southern Economic Association Conference Washington DC
April 2024	Presented at: Population Association of America Columbus, Ohio
Jan 2024	Econometrics Society Conference New Delhi, India
June 2023	Presented at: American Society for Health Economics St. Louis, Missouri
May 2023	Presented at: SANEM Annual Economists’ Conference Washington DC
May 2023	Presented at: American Council for Consumer Interests Conference Las Vegas, Nevada
Nov 2022	Southern Economic Association Conference Fort Lauderdale, Florida
Oct 2021 – Jan 2022	Training on Behavioral Policy making in India Ashoka University, India
Jun 2020	Summer Training Behavioral and Experimental Economics Prof. Shagata Mukherjee, India

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITIES

ECINEQ PhD Conference, 2025	Organized a PhD conference , co-hosted by ECINEQ, The World Bank Group and GWU
Development Seminar Director, 2024 – Present	Organizing a seminar series for PhD students, to present their work and receive constructive feedback at the department of Economics at GWU
Capacity Development Forum, Bangalore, India, 2024	Organized a workshop on the concepts, methods and tools for designing behavioral interventions for Public Policy, hosted by the Indian Institute for Human Settlements (IIHS)
CSSA Vice President, 2022	Consumer Sciences Student Association at UW-Madison, USA
PEOPLE’s Initiative, 2022	Conducted a four-day training workshop to educate highschoolers about Consumer Behavior which culminated with a presentation in front of the UW Madison faculty.
Team Engagement at Office, India, 2018-2021	Organized team building fun activities in the workplace at EXL and HSBC
Placement Coordinator, India, 2015-2017	Facilitated conducting interviews for graduating students during master’s course at JNU